Monday, November 9, 2026

Dain Weekly · World Brief

Global news for English learners

DAIN EDU

USA · POLITICS

Democrats win the U.S. House in the midterms

- Major outlets projected on Nov 4 that Democrats will take control of the House of Representatives.
- Some projections also point to a Senate flip, but several races were still close and counts are unofficial.
- Hakeem Jeffries launched a bid for Speaker; Mike Johnson said he was “disappointed”.

midterms	elections held halfway through a president's term
majority	more than half of the seats
to flip	to change from one party to the other

ABC News, Al Jazeera

WORLD · IRAN & UKRAINE

Midterm loss raises questions on the Iran war and Ukraine talks

- Vice President Vance said the “obvious” reason Republicans lost was the Iran war.
- Russia said it hopes the results will not change Trump's Ukraine negotiations.
- Observers note Ukraine still enjoys bipartisan support in Washington.

negotiations	formal talks to reach an agreement
bipartisan	supported by both main parties
fallout	negative results of an event

ABC News, wire reports

ISRAEL · POLITICS

Herzog asks Gadi Eisenkot to try to form Israel's government

- Eisenkot reportedly received 67 recommendations from lawmakers; Netanyahu received 46.
- Arab-led lists backed him, but he has ruled out governing with them.
- The nominee gets 28 days to build a coalition, with a possible 14-day extension.

coalition	a group of parties governing together
to nominate	to formally choose someone for a role
deadlock	a situation where no progress is possible

Al Jazeera, Africanews, SCMP

PARAGUAY · POLITICS

President Peña resigns as impeachment moves ahead

- The collapse of Ueno Bank triggered a political crisis in Paraguay.
- Deputies voted to start impeachment minutes after Peña announced his resignation.
- Reports on the final outcome conflict, so check local media for updates.

impeachment	a process to remove an official from office
to resign	to leave a job voluntarily
collapse	a sudden failure

AP, Bloomberg Línea, El Nuevo Día

BRAZIL · ECONOMY

Brazil lists 27 strategic minerals

- Brazil's new council, with President Lula present, approved its first list of critical and strategic minerals.
- Rare earths and copper sit at the top of the list.
- Brazil holds the world's second-largest rare-earth reserves, after China (USGS).

rare earths	metals used in phones, EVs and wind turbines
reserves	the amount of a resource that can be extracted
strategic	important for long-term national goals

Bloomberg Línea

Word Power

Five words from today's news. Say each one in a sentence!

majority *noun*	Democrats won a majority in the House.
coalition *noun*	He must build a coalition to govern.
to resign *verb*	The president announced he would resign.
bipartisan *adj.*	Ukraine has bipartisan support.
reserves *noun*	Brazil has huge rare-earth reserves.

Headline Grammar

- News headlines use the present simple for past events: “Democrats win House” = Democrats won the House.
- Infinitives show the future: “Peña to face trial” = Peña will face trial.
- Articles disappear: “Herzog asks Eisenkot to form government.”
- Try it: rewrite “Brazil lists 27 minerals” as a full sentence in the past.

Quick Quiz

1. Which party won the U.S. House? → Democrats
2. How many days does Eisenkot get to form a coalition? → 28 (+14)
3. Which mineral group tops Brazil's list? → Rare earths & copper
4. “Bipartisan” means supported by...? → both main parties

Sources: ABC News, AP, Africanews, Al Jazeera, Bloomberg Línea, El Nuevo Día, SCMP, wire reports

Headlines compiled from public reports as of Nov 8–9, 2026. Figures are preliminary; check the original outlets.